CONCLUSION

This is a critically important issue for this administration in the United States and for the next. There are many problems. Among the most important are governance and the building of Afghan capacity in all areas, drug cultivation and export, security in the border areas, the future of Pakistan and its critical role in Afghanistan, and cooperation among our allies.

The urgency is real. The problems can be dealt with. It will require new and enlarged efforts by this committee and the Legislative and Executive branches together.

I look forward to your questions and comments.

Chairman Berman. Thank you. Our situation, panelists in general, is that we now have about 3 minutes to get to the floor to cast the first of what might be as few as six or as many as 12 votes, depending on the temperature on that side of the aisle, but not here but on the House floor. So, and I know *Ambassador Holbrooke* has to leave at noon. But my guess is the rest of you have plans as well. So we will get back here as quickly as possible or try to make arrangements for you to do what you need to do. I will come back at the end of these votes. But they usually are 5-minute votes so which the good news is they will be done quicker, the bad news is we cannot get back here in time to proceed with the hearing before we go for the next vote. So hope some of you will be here when we get back.

[Recess.]

Chairman Berman. There are two critical people to hear your testimony, General, and both of them happen to be here. We are in the middle of the votes but this one is a 15-minute vote so we thought we would come back to try and move through and get this.

General, is this good for you?

General Jones. Yes, it is.

Chairman Berman. All right.

STATEMENT OF GENERAL JAMES L. JONES, USMC, RETIRED, PRESIDENT AND CEO , INSTITUTE FOR 21ST CENTURY ENERGY (FORMER SUPREME ALLIED COMMANDER, EUROPE)

General Jones. Thank you very much.

Thank you, Mr. Chairman. Mr. Chairman, I will have just a short introduction and then we can get to your questions which I think will be more interesting.

First, I would like to tell you how appreciative I am to be at the same table with Ambassadors Holbrooke and Pickering, both of whom I have known for a long time and have been very supportive and helpful to me in my official capacities as Commandant of the Marine Corps and, more specifically, as the NATO Commander and the Commander of United States Forces in Europe. And so it is a great pleasure to be with both of them to talk about this very, very difficult problem, and a problem that is of central importance to the security of the United States.

My expertise lies more on the Afghan side of the border. I wanted to say that up front. Although I did have some dialogue with the Pakistani military in 2006 when NATO assumed responsibility for, completed its expansion in Afghanistan and assumed responsibility for

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